

**GIVE AND TAKE**

Written by  
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EXT. CHURCH - NIGHT

WIDE. Long take. A small church sits still under streetlight.

A MAN lurks in the shadows of the church wall. His upper body is in complete darkness, but cigarette smoke puffs out of the darkness and is illuminated by the streetlight.

A BROTHER emerges from the church, locks the door with his keys, and walks away, turning a corner out of sight.

The Man waits. Then -

CUT TO:

INT. CHURCH ENTRANCE - CONTINUOUS

HANDHELD. Frantic cuts. Close-ups of hands picking the locks. Opens the door. Closes the door. The Man's appearance now revealed. Disheveled. Raggy clothes. Poorly shaven. His face is flustered, sweating, desperate, and angry.

CUT TO:

EXT. CHURCH - CONTINUOUS

Static shot of the corner where the Brother disappeared. A beat. Then the Brother's head cautiously peeks out, eyes looking back toward the church.

CUT TO:

INT. CHURCH - CONTINUOUS

The Man moves through the dim interior. He finds the donation box, struggles to pry it open, then smashes it in frustration. Money scatters across the floor.

He crouches to collect it. As he looks up -

He makes eye contact with a CRUCIFIX on the wall. It watches him. Judging.

The Man stares back. Pauses.

MAN

(to the crucifix)

Don't look at me like that. You think I feel bad? You stole all my shit. Lost my job, lost my money, I can't pay for good food. I have to suffer through Little Caesar's.

He keeps gathering the money.

MAN (CONT'D)

But then it's cold. So I reheat it.

In the background, the church door opens quietly. The audience hears it. The Man does not.

MAN (CONT'D)

And then you let it burn down my house.

How was I supposed to know you can't put the whole pizza box in the oven?

I'm not omniscient!

He stands, bag in hand, voice cracking slightly. Audience sees the door in the background open, out of focus.

MAN (CONT'D)

Because of you... I have nothing.

A shuffling noise behind him. He spins around and whips out a puny dollar-store pocket knife.

The shot frames the Brother as standing tall, imposing, and judgemental figure, looking down from the aisle.

CUT TO:

The Brother calmly crouches, picking up the scattered money from the floor, and placing it into the Man's bag.

MAN

Stop moving!

The Brother keeps going. Unhurried.

MAN (CONT'D)

(louder but voice cracking)

Put the stuff in the bag!

BROTHER

(a little sass)

That's what I'm doing.

The Brother places the last of the money in the bag, and very subtly slips in a rosary as well. He stands and holds the bag out to the Man.

The Man stares confused. Unnerved by the Brother's complete lack of fear, the Man calls it quits and bolts for the door.

The Brother moves fast. He stops the Man and grabs his shoulders. Firm, strong, but not violent.

BROTHER

Here.

He holds the bag out again. The Man stares at him, breathing hard, knife still in hand.

BROTHER (CONT'D)

The Lord gives and the Lord takes away.

A beat. The Man blinks and his expression softens. The Brother smiles.

BROTHER (CONT'D)

And then He gives again.

The Man maintains eye contact with the Brother as he yanks the bag from him. His eyes start to tear up. With the knife in one hand and the bag in the other, the Man pulls the Brother into a hug.

CUT TO TITLE CARD.